

LIGHTS, CAMERA, IMPACT
Short Film Contest
Web Page Content

**Let Us Dream Triennial International Conference
(LUD TICC 2026)**

Lights. Camera. Impact

The Let Us Dream Triennial International Conference 2026, in collaboration with the Department of Media Studies, CHRIST Deemed to be University, invites filmmakers, storytellers, students, and creative minds to participate in Lights. Camera.Impact., the official Short Film Competition of the conference.

Inspired by the conference theme, "Local Wisdom, Global Influence," the competition encourages participants to create compelling short films that celebrate local perspectives, inspire dialogue, and drive meaningful social impact through the power of visual storytelling.

Whether you are an aspiring filmmaker or an experienced creator, this is your opportunity to showcase your creativity, share stories that matter, and present your work on an international platform.

Register now and let your story create an impact.

Please read the Competition Guidelines provided below carefully before proceeding with your registration. Once you have reviewed the guidelines, you may register for the competition using the registration link provided at the end of this page.

LET US DREAM TRIENNIAL INTERNATIONAL CONFERENCE -2026

Short Film Contest – Rules & Regulations

Theme: Local Wisdom, Global Influence

Sub themes: Education, Health, Social

1. Purpose of the Contest: The Short Film Contest aims to encourage participants to create meaningful films that inspire awareness, promote positive social change, and reflect the values and mission of LUD. Participants are encouraged to tell compelling stories that **educate, inspire,** and **engage audiences** through creative visual storytelling.

2. Eligibility

Participants

- The contest is open to students, independent filmmakers, professionals, and the general public.
- Individual and team entries are permitted.
- Each team shall nominate one Team Leader for all official communication.

Number of Entries: Each individual/team may submit only one film.

Age: The contest is open to participants of all eligible ages.

3. Contest Theme

Every film must directly relate to the official contest theme “**Education, Health ,Social** ”. Films that deviate substantially from the announced theme may be rejected during the screening process. The organizers reserve the right to determine whether a film sufficiently addresses the competition theme.

4. Film Duration

Minimum duration: 3 Minutes

Maximum duration: 10 Minutes

The duration includes: Opening Titles, Credits, Logos, Sponsor slides, End Credits
Films exceeding the maximum duration may receive penalties or may be disqualified.

5. Language: Films may be produced in any language. However, English subtitles are mandatory for films in languages other than English. Subtitles must be readable and synchronized.

6. Originality: The submitted film must be: Original, Produced by the participant/team, Free from plagiarism. The participant confirms that: Story, Script, Dialogues, Editing, Graphics, Music, Animation, Visual Effects either belong to them or are legally licensed. The organizers shall not be responsible for copyright disputes arising from submitted films.

7. Copyright & Intellectual Property: Participants retain ownership of their films. However, by submitting an entry, participants grant the organizers a non-exclusive, royalty-free license to: Screen the film, Promote the competition, Showcase selected entries, Use excerpts for publicity, Archive the film for future educational and awareness initiatives. The film will never be commercially sold without the creator's written permission.

8. Content Guidelines: The film must not contain Hate speech, Defamation, Pornographic material, Excessive violence, Graphic gore, Religious hatred, Political propaganda, Racism, Discrimination, Child abuse, Animal cruelty, Illegal activities portrayed as acceptable. Films containing sensitive subjects should treat them responsibly and ethically.

9. Technical Specifications:

Preferred Resolution: 1920 × 1080 (Full HD)

Accepted Formats: MP4, MOV

Aspect Ratio: 16:9 preferred

Orientation: Landscape

Audio: Clear dialogue with minimal background **noise**.

10. AI Usage Policy: The contest welcomes responsible use of AI as a creative tool, provided it supports (not replaces) the participant's original work. Participants must disclose significant use of AI in areas such as Scriptwriting, Image generation, Voice synthesis, Animation, Visual effects.

Films that are entirely AI-generated will be ineligible, depending on the competition guidelines.

11. Submission Requirements:

Participants shall submit:

Final Film

Poster

Participant Details

Synopsis (150 Words)

*Consent Form

Copyright Declaration

Mode of Submission: Google Drive link (You shall upload your film to Google Drive and submit the shareable link through the submission form).

12. Submission Deadline: No submissions will be accepted after the official deadline, i.e., 10th October 2026. The organizers are not responsible for Slow internet, Corrupted files, Upload failures, Incorrect links Participants are encouraged to submit early.

13. Preliminary Screening: Before judging, all entries will undergo an eligibility review. Films may be rejected if they:

Do not follow the theme

Exceed duration

Have missing subtitles (or not having a comprehensible audio)

Are technically unplayable

Violate copyright

Contain inappropriate content

14. Judging Criteria:

Scoring rubric (100 Marks):

Criteria	Marks	Rules
Theme Relevance	20	Does the film meaningfully explore the competition theme?
Storytelling	20	Is the narrative coherent? Does it have a compelling beginning, middle, and end? Is the pacing effective?

Creativity & Originality	10	Originality, innovation, and artistic approach.
Direction	15	Quality of creative vision, actor guidance, and scene execution.
Cinematography	10	Composition, framing, lighting, and camera movement.
Editing	10	Continuity, rhythm, transitions, and storytelling flow.
Sound Design & Music	10	Dialogue clarity, sound design, and appropriate use of music.
Emotional/Social Impact	5	Emotional resonance and potential to inspire positive change.

15. Decision of the Jury: The jury's decision shall be final. No correspondence regarding scores, rankings, or judging comments will be entertained.

16. Awards:

Top six movies will be awarded as Best Film and will be screened during the LUD Triennial International Conference hosted and held at CHRIST Deemed to be University, Central Campus, Bengaluru

The organizers reserve the right not to present an award if no suitable entry is received.

17. Participant Responsibilities: Participants are responsible for ensuring accurate submission information, Copyright compliance, Model releases where required, Location permissions, Safe filming practices.

The organizers assume no responsibility for accidents, injuries, or damages incurred during production.

18. Disqualification:

Entries may be disqualified for:

False information

Copyright infringement

Offensive content

Plagiarism

Multiple submissions under different names
Failure to comply with these rules
Attempting to influence judges or organizers

19. Organizer Rights:

The organizers reserve the right to:

Modify competition schedules if necessary.
Amend these rules in exceptional circumstances.
Cancel or postpone the competition due to unforeseen events (force majeure).
Use submitted stills, trailers, posters, and short clips for promotional purposes.
Verify the authenticity of any submitted work.

20. Acceptance of Rules: Submission of a film constitutes full acceptance of all contest rules and regulations. Failure to comply with these guidelines may result in disqualification.

21. Ethical Filmmaking Policy: The LUD is committed to promoting ethical, respectful, and responsible storytelling. Participants are expected to uphold these principles throughout the filmmaking process.

Participants shall ensure that: Every individual featured in the film has voluntarily agreed to participate. No person is misrepresented, exploited, humiliated, or portrayed in a misleading manner. Vulnerable individuals and marginalized communities are treated with dignity and respect. Stories are presented truthfully and responsibly without sensationalism. Participants avoid manipulating facts or creating misleading narratives for dramatic effect.

The organizers reserve the right to reject films that violate ethical storytelling standards.

22. Child Protection & Safeguarding Policy: Any film involving children (persons under 18 years of age) must comply with child protection guidelines.

Participants must ensure:

Written consent has been obtained from the child's parent or legal guardian.
Children are filmed in a safe, respectful, and age-appropriate manner.
No child is exposed to dangerous situations during filming.
No identifying personal information is unnecessarily disclosed.
Children are never portrayed in degrading, exploitative, or harmful contexts.

The organizers may request proof of parental consent if necessary. Failure to comply may result in immediate disqualification.

23. Privacy and Consent: Participants are responsible for obtaining permission from individuals appearing in the film.

Where applicable, participants should obtain:

Model Release Forms

Property Release Forms

Organization Permissions

Location Permissions

The organizers shall not be liable for privacy or consent disputes arising after submission.

24. Environmental Responsibility: The organizers encourage environmentally responsible filmmaking.

Participants are encouraged to:

Avoid littering during production.

Respect wildlife and natural habitats.

Avoid damaging public or private property.

Use reusable materials whenever possible.

Leave filming locations clean after production.

Films involving environmental destruction during production may be disqualified.

25. Accessibility Guidelines: To make the competition inclusive, participants are encouraged to consider accessibility.

Recommended practices include:

Clear English subtitles.

Readable font size.

Adequate subtitle contrast.

Clear dialogue recording.

Avoid excessively flashing imagery that may affect viewers with photosensitive epilepsy.

Accessibility will not be mandatory unless specifically announced but may positively influence audience engagement.

26. Code of Conduct: All participants, mentors, volunteers, judges, and guests are expected to behave professionally.

Participants shall:

Treat fellow participants with respect.

Respect judges' decisions.

Follow venue rules.

Cooperate with organizers.

Avoid harassment, discrimination, intimidation, or abusive behavior.

Any misconduct may result in removal from the event.

27. Health & Safety: Participants are responsible for ensuring safe filming practices.

The organizers strongly discourage:

Dangerous stunts.

Filming on railway tracks.

Filming on highways without permission.

Trespassing.

Use of firearms or explosive materials.

Risking personal safety for cinematic shots.

The organizers shall not be responsible for injuries sustained during production.

28. Frequently Asked Questions (FAQs)

Can we submit a film already published on YouTube?

Yes, provided you own all rights to the film and it was published within two years from the event. However, the organizers may choose to prioritize premieres or unpublished works depending on the competition guidelines.

Can we use mobile phones?

Yes. Films may be shot using smartphones, DSLR cameras, mirrorless cameras, camcorders, drones (where legally permitted), or any other recording device.

Can animation be submitted?

No. Live-action, experimental films are welcome.

Can we use AI-generated content?

Yes, provided it complies with the AI Usage Policy and is properly disclosed.

Can we submit after the deadline?

No. Late submissions will not be accepted unless an official extension is announced.

Can one participant be involved in multiple teams?

Yes, but a participant may only be listed as the primary entrant for one submission.

Can we withdraw our submission?

Yes. Participants may withdraw their film by submitting a written request before the judging process begins.

https://docs.google.com/forms/d/e/1FAIpQLSdLfERI_xkkO8z-RFkAxanT2_2cKAnFUjmU5OvNYLtxmV192w/viewform?usp=header - registration link

For more details contact : ludshortfilmcontest@gmail.com

: conference@letusdream.org